issues. Therefore, even though the Congress dominated the political scene from 1947 to 1977, India's many other political parties played the role of the Opposition in Parliament.

A strong opposition plays an important role in the political life of a democracy. They critique the ruling government's policies, and ask questions to help keep it in check. They also offer a diversity of perspectives on key issues. In India's federal system, they have also ensured that states have a greater say in and greater freedom to make decisions on issues affecting them.

In this section, you will read about some of the founders and leaders of these other parties and the impact they had.

ELAMKULAM MANAKKAL SANKARAN NAMBOODIRIPAD

1909–1998